

Dusting 'em OFF

by Sports Editor
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Powers has done it himself—Cohen

A year ago John C. Powers, a graduate of Birmingham sandlot baseball, was a pathetic lefthanded hitter against lefthanded pitching. He looked like an old woman swinging at a bumble bee with a pine straw.

Andy Cohen, Pelican manager, was asked:

"What in the world changed Powers into a slugger against lefthanders?"

"I can't claim any of the credit," said Andy.

"He has done it himself through hard work and determination."

"He has learned to lay off bad pitches. He has not only improved his hitting but he is a much improved outfielder."



"Yes, I would say he has a fine chance to stick with the Pittsburgh club next year."

Every boy who aspires to play professional baseball should be interested in the story of how John C. Powers has improved as a ball player. John played in the East-West boys' baseball game in 1946. He was chosen to represent Alabama in the Esquire American AllBoys game in Chicago.

POWERS It hasn't been easy for John, despite his terrific power. He has had to concentrate on fielding as well as learning how to hit the southpaws.

Few lefthanded hitters have ever put on a finer show of hitting lefthanders than John did in the Baron-Pelican double-header. John and Emil Panko give the Pels the best right-left punch in the league.

Powers came within three home runs of Panko, the league's leading home run hitter, when he hit his 22nd homer off Stan Johnson. With two more games to play here, John could take over the lead before home folks.

Pelicans shooting for first division

New Orleans is threatening to do what Mobile did a year ago. The Pelicans are threatening to move into the first division and a shot at playing in the Dixie Series.

"We have had a fine, spirited team all year," says Andy Cohen. "They have never let up trying to win. The players have refused to be discouraged."

"I have managed a long time but never a club that had more team spirit than this one. The players believe they can make the playoffs."

Andy shied away from the question: "What club's going to win the pennant?"

"Too much can happen," said Andy.

"Memphis and Atlanta have staged great comebacks."

"Birmingham is not out of it if the pitching comes around again."



"I am interested in seeing the Pelicans get in the playoff. I believe it would be good for baseball in New Orleans. We haven't had it too good."

New Orleans is ending up with the finest trio of outfielders in the league. Two fine sluggers in Emil Panko and John Powers. And a great all-around outfielder in Gail Henley.

Many thought Al Grunwald was the best first baseman in the league at All-Star game time. He is now with his fielding and driving runs across the plate.

Pels only club outhomering Barons at Woods

It just seems the visiting clubs are hitting more home runs at Rickwood than the Barons. The impression comes from the 18 homers the visitors have hit against 12 for the Barons in the last 11 games.

New Orleans is the only club to hit more homers than the Barons—thanks to John Powers' five circuit clouts. The Pels have hit nine to the Barons' seven.

The Barons are up on the Crackers, Rebels, Lookouts and Chicks. They are tied with the Vols and Bears.

The Barons started out like the home run hitting club of the league with Gerald MacKay, John Jacuk and Frank Wehner pasting the ball. Once the pitchers got the bead on them they simmered down.

John Blanchard came into the league with the reputation of a home run hitter with a modern record of 34 in the Eastern League. He never has been able to show his 1955 power while Emil Panko, in the same league, has been the big surprise.

Rickwood Field is the fairest park for left and right handed power hitters in the league. It favors neither the left handed hitter nor the right handed hitter.

Here's the home run record of each club, compared with the Barons.

The Barons have hit 46 homers against the opposition's 36.

Atlanta	8	Birmingham	9
Chattanooga	1	Birmingham	3
Montgomery	4	Birmingham	9
Memphis	3	Birmingham	7
Mobile	8	Birmingham	8
Nashville	3	Birmingham	3
New Orleans	9	Birmingham	7
TOTALS	36	Birmingham	46